



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

JCF Policy and Standard Operating Procedures for the Management of Social Research

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1.0 Introduction

Increasingly, law enforcement entities in contemporary liberal democracies rely heavily on sound empirical data/information for decision-making at the strategic, operational and tactical levels. The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) is no exception. As the agency with the mandate for crime and disorder prevention, detection and solution, data/information has become the major linchpin on which the organization's priorities, strategies, policies and standard operating procedures are contemplated, developed, executed and monitored.

Social research plays a critical role in providing empirical data/information for knowledge management within the JCF. For its part, research transcends and mitigates errors in ordinary human enquiry, and has guided the discovery of a plethora of law enforcement theories, models, approaches, apparatuses etcetera, all of which aided members' understanding of the social world in which they operate.

Akin to increasing the understanding of the policing landscape, social research provides a framework for more insights of what works and by extension, what does not work across time, in different jurisdictions and within particular context. In this regard, the JCF through social research is positioned to adopt and adapt proven strategies, policies and approaches to address contemporary policing challenges to effectively fulfil its mandate.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this policy and standard operating procedures is to provide a framework for the management of social research within the JCF.

3.0 Scope

This policy and standard operating procedures apply to members engaged in social research as components of their duties as well as in cases where the organization collaborates with individuals or entities in joint research projects.

4.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
PRDB	Planning, Research and Development Branch
FDLP	Force Development and Logistics Portfolio

5.0 Policy Statements

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) recognises that its continued relevance and ability to satisfy stakeholders rest heavily on the extent to which it is able to make decisions derived from sound, objective and empirical information and up-to-date research. Against this background, the organization will conduct or collaborate with individuals or institutions that conduct studies designed to contribute to the discourse and knowledge of law enforcement or the wider security sector. It is therefore the policy that:

- 5.1 during the annual planning session, the Director, Planning, Research and Development Branch (PRDB) will develop an Annual Research Schedule of studies that will be undertaken for the successive year;
- 5.2 the Deputy Commissioner of Police, Force Development and Logistics Portfolio (FDLP) will review and approve the Annual Research Schedule;

- 5.3 the PRDB will conduct social research designed to contribute to the discourse and knowledge of the JCF, law enforcement or to the wider security sector;
- 5.4 the organization may collaborate with persons or institutions to conduct studies that are designed to contribute to the discourse and knowledge of law enforcement or to the wider security sector;
- 5.5 prior to the commencement of, or involvement in any research that will impact national security or organizational policy, the researcher or entity responsible for conducting the research must clearly articulate the research objective(s), and obtain approval from the High Command;
- 5.6 approval for research will be granted only where studies will be consistent with organizational policies and serve the public interests;
- 5.7 all studies conducted by, or on behalf of the Force shall be in a manner that protects the interests of the JCF, national security, and safeguard the privacy, confidentiality and anonymity of all subjects;
- 5.8 where collaborative studies involve collecting data about the public, the researcher must first obtain *research ethics approval* from their respective institutions and approval from the High Command before commencing;
- 5.9 collaborative research projects with other organisations that are subject to external funding, require written agreements and will take into account international conventions, local laws, policies and regulations;
- 5.10 in collaborative research, where applicable, all researchers must be made aware of, and indicate their understanding of, and agreement to comply with all related laws, policies and written agreements. These include those relating to intellectual property, publication and dissemination of research results, and the management of research data and primary materials; and
- 5.11 public release of findings of research must be authorised by High Command.

6.0 Standard Operating Procedures

The following shall apply when undertaking research:

6.1 Problem Identification

The head of the Research Unit or designee shall collect background information and discuss with research team the nature and description of the problem, objectives of the research (to explore, explain or describe) and the rationale or significance of the study.

6.2 Literature Review

The research team shall then conduct a review of related literature. The review should examine, *inter alia* how the study relates to a larger on-going dialogue surrounding the topic, and provide an overview of specific theoretical/conceptual/analytical frameworks. Depending on the nature of the

study, the review may be; contextual, historical, integrative, methodological, self-study, or theoretical.

6.3 Research Design

6.3.1 Once the research team has completed the review of literature, the next step is to design the study by creating a framework or plan which will guide the research. The research design should indicate the type of study that will be undertaken. These include:

- i) Exploratory
- ii) Descriptive and
- iii) Explanatory/Analytical/Causal Design (Experimental Design).

6.3.2 Other elements to be considered are design types such as: Cohort, Longitudinal, Cross-Sectional or Case Study.

6.3.3 The research team must also determine; i) research question(s)/hypothesis(es) to be answered; ii) conceptual and operational definitions of key variables; iii) methodology which includes methods, population and sampling, iv) instrument design; v) data collection, analysis and presentation.

6.4 Fieldwork

Once the research has been designed, the research team conducts the fieldwork. These may include conducting the range of interviews, observations, document reviews, administration of questionnaires, focus group sessions, amongst others in an effort to find data to address the research problems.

6.5 Findings and Analysis

Once the fieldwork is completed, the team must collate the findings via a combination of appropriate narration, tables, charts and graphs. The findings component includes extraction of the questions or elements that guided the enquiry, and the corresponding results unearthed during fieldwork. The analysis component includes making sense of the data. This involves moving from descriptive to inferential analysis in respect to quantitative data. In relation to qualitative data, the approach is to transform huge volume of raw data via; i) data reduction, ii) data display and iii) conclusions and verification.

6.6 Conclusion and Recommendations

6.6.1 The conclusion and recommendations sections may be combined or, in extensive studies, presented in separate sections. In extensive studies, the conclusion and recommendations may be presented in point form. The conclusion must relate directly to the research questions or hypothesis, highlight the significant features of the research design, summarise the key findings of the discussions, and detail the dominant outcomes of the research. It may also outline the extent to which the study's aim was achieved while acknowledging the limitations.

- 6.6.2 The recommendations should be guided by the research findings and propose solutions. This section may also contain components that make recommendations for future related studies.

6.7 Structure of Research

The research must contain the following elements:

6.7.1 Title Page

This page must contain the words ‘Jamaica Constabulary Force’ below the insignia of the Force, followed by the given title of the study. The title page must also contain the name(s) of the person or Formation that undertook the study and the date when it was released.

6.7.2 Executive Summary

This is a summary or preview comprising of 5 – 10 percent of the main ingredients of the study. The Executive Summary must comprise a synopsis of the purpose, scope, methods, results, conclusion and recommendations of the study.

6.7.3 Acknowledgements

The acknowledgement must include recognition of the organization’s indebtedness to person(s) and entities that have availed themselves in support of the study.

6.7.4 Table of Content

The study must have a ‘Table of Content’ page which should include; the Executive Summary, Acknowledgements, Table of Cases, Table of Statutes, Table of Constitutional Instruments, Glossary, List of Figures, List of Tables, the major headings and sub-headings, List of References, and Appendices.

6.7.5 Table of Cases (where applicable)

The study must contain a list in alphabetical order of all the judicial decisions that were cited or referenced in the study.

6.7.6 Table of Statutes (where applicable)

The study must contain a list in alphabetical order of all the laws that were cited or referenced in the study.

6.7.7 Table of Constitutional Instruments (if any)

The study must contain a list in alphabetical order of all the constitutional instruments that were cited or referenced in the study.

6.7.8 Glossary

Where key words or terms were used, there should be a Glossary which lists and defines/explains the key words or terms in alphabetical order.

6.7.9 List of Figures, Tables, Illustrations, Charts, etc.

Where appropriate, the study must contain a list of figures, tables, illustrations, charts et cetera.

6.7.10 Introduction

The study must contain an introduction which should include some or all of the following elements, as appropriate: an overview, a brief statement of the research question or hypothesis that needs resolution or aim at filling a knowledge gap, a statement outlining the purpose/rationale and motivation for doing the research, and the policy relevance or law enforcement implications for conducting the study.

6.7.11 Literature Review

All research must contain a literature review. This component provides an analytical overview of the subject and is linked to specific theoretical/conceptual/analytical frameworks. The review must serve to place the study within the larger context of previous works. It must include identification, conceptualization and operationalization of variable, establishment of the need for research by identifying gaps, and indicate knowledge in the area of focus.

6.7.12 Methodology

This is outlining the design of the research. It includes a revisit of the research problem and a review of the detailed description of how data will be collected and analyzed. The methodology chapter must detail: i) instrument design (including instrument testing); ii) identification of the study population; iii) sample frame and sampling strategy; iv) detail of data collection; v) data analysis and reporting strategy.

6.7.13 Findings

This section must outline new insights that have emerged from the data collected and analyzed. The findings may be supported by appropriate graphs, tables and figures.

6.7.14 Discussions/Conclusions/Recommendations

The study must contain a 'Discussions', 'Conclusion', and 'Recommendations' section(s) that may be integrated or represented severally. This component of the study may provide answers or insights into the theoretical and/or practical implications drawn from the 'results'. Or, it may provide implications of the research for the understanding and practice of the area under study. The section may also include suggestions for further studies.

6.7.15 References

This section of the study details all the sources used in the research. The paper must have one consistent referencing style.

6.7.16 Appendices

Appendices contain materials important to the understanding of the study. They should be numbered and form part of the sequence of pages bearing

Arabic numerals. Each appendix must have a title which is descriptive of its contents. A list of Appendices must be included in the Table of Contents.

The Research Process Flow

